

ALI AKARMA

AI Safety & Agentic AI Researcher

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www.aliakarma.codes | [GitHub](https://github.com/aliakarma) | [Google Scholar](https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=aliakarma) | [LinkedIn](https://www.linkedin.com/in/aliakarma) | [ORCID: 0009-0002-6687-9380](https://orcid.org/0009-0002-6687-9380)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Trustworthy agentic AI systems, AI safety and alignment, constrained multi-agent reinforcement learning (C-Dec-POMDP, Lagrangian CTDE), AI governance and oversight architectures, adversarial robustness of LLM-based autonomous pipelines, blockchain-anchored audit mechanisms for safety-critical deployments, and digital twin frameworks for smart city infrastructure.

EDUCATION

B.S. Information Technology — Islamic University of Madinah, Saudi Arabia 2023 -- 2027

- GPA: 4.29 / 5.00 — *Merit-based fully funded scholarship (competitive international selection)*
- Relevant coursework: Machine Learning, Algorithms & Data Structures, Probability & Statistics, Database Systems, Software Engineering
- Thesis interest: Safety-aligned multi-agent orchestration under Byzantine constraints

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Intern — King Fahd University of Petroleum and Minerals (KFUPM) Jun 2026 -- Present

- Investigating AI decision-making verification for wildfire suppression and mitigation strategies in Middle East environments using reinforcement learning and multi-agent systems.
- Developing evaluation protocols for safety, reliability, and trustworthiness of autonomous agent policies under distributional shift and adversarial conditions.

Undergraduate AI Researcher — Islamic University of Madinah Jan 2025 -- Present

- Designed constrained multi-agent RL architectures (C-Dec-POMDP, Lagrangian CTDE) for safety-critical disaster prediction, achieving 81.5 reward with 2.3% safety violation rate across six baselines on meteorological data from the Saudi National Center for Meteorology.
- Evaluated adversarial prompt-injection and jailbreak failure modes in autonomous LLM-agent pipelines; built a LangChain prompt-injection defence middleware with three detection modes and four policy strategies.
- Led development of governance-constrained agentic AI framework for wildfire monitoring with human-supervised governance framework for safety-critical AI systems (first-author, ICETAS 2026).
- Built 10+ open-source research prototypes with reproducible pipelines, pytest suites, and Zenodo-archived datasets, spanning healthcare (AgHealth+, ADAPT), disaster response (LagrangianCTDE), smart cities (AquaAgent), and finance (FinNutriAgent).

GRANT-FUNDED RESEARCH

King Salman Center for Disability Research (KSCDR) — Research Group No. KSRG-2026-321

- **ADAPT**: An agentic AI framework for disability-inclusive nutrition and healthcare monitoring. *Published in Journal of Disability Research*.

DOI: [10.57197/JDR-2026-0830](https://doi.org/10.57197/JDR-2026-0830) | GitHub: github.com/aliakarma/ADAPT

- **FedAgent-Chain**: A secure federated and agentic AI framework for multilingual disability-inclusive employment in AI cities. *Published in MDPI Smart Cities*.

DOI: [10.3390/smartcities9070106](https://doi.org/10.3390/smartcities9070106) | GitHub: github.com/aliakarma/fedagent-chain

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

Google Scholar: 57 citations, h-index 5, i10-index 2.

First-Author Papers

- **Akarma, A.**, Syed, T.A., Jan, S., Muneer, H., Jilani, A.K. "Governance-Constrained Agentic AI: Blockchain-Enforced Human Oversight for Safety-Critical Wildfire Monitoring," **ICETAS 2026**. [arXiv:2604.04265](https://arxiv.org/abs/2604.04265)
- **Akarma, A.**, Syed, T.A., Jilani, A.K., Jan, S., Muneer, H., Khan, M.A., Yu, C. "Agents for Agents: An Interrogator-Based Secure Framework for Autonomous Internet of Underwater Things," **ICETAS 2026**. [arXiv:2604.04262](https://arxiv.org/abs/2604.04262)

- Syed TA, **Akarma A**, Alatif A, Naqash MT, Alqurashi A. "Agentic AI-enhanced digital twins for Smart City civil infrastructure: A secure, autonomous and auditable management framework" **PLOS ONE**. [10.1371/journal.pone.0353610](https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0353610) (Co-First Author)
- **Akarma, A.**, Syed, T.A., Hameed, D., Muneer, H. "Improving Disability Support and Institutional Performance With AI," Book Chapter, **IGI Global** (Accepted).

Journal Articles

- Jan, S., **Akarma, A.**, Syed, T.A. et al. "EAGF: a four-pillar ethical AI governance framework for trustworthy cybersecurity in 5G renewable energy IoT systems". **Scientific Reports** 2026. [10.1038/s41598-026-63383-5](https://doi.org/10.1038/s41598-026-63383-5).
- Syed, T. A., **Akarma, A.**, Naqash, M. T., Hameed, D., Kamal, S., & Formisano, A. "Agentic AI for Climate-Resilient Cities: A PRISMA-Guided Review and Digital Twin Framework," **MDPI Sustainability** (Accepted).
- Syed, T. A., Alshahrani, A., **Akarma, A.**, Khan, S., Nauman, M., Lee, I. E., ... & Ullah, A. "FinNutriAgent (FNA): An Agentic AI for Budget and Nutrition Planning," **ETASR**, 2026. [10.48084/etasr.15640](https://doi.org/10.48084/etasr.15640)

Conference Papers

- Syed, T. A., Alshahrani, A., Ullah, A., **Akarma, A.**, Khan, S., Nauman, M., & Jan, S. "FinAgent: Agentic AI for Personal Finance and Nutrition," **IEEE ICCA 2025**. [10.1109/ICCA66035.2025.11430760](https://doi.org/10.1109/ICCA66035.2025.11430760)
- Jan, S., Razzaqi, H. A., **Akarma, A.**, & Belgaum, M. R "Blockchain-Monitored Agentic AI Architecture for Trusted Perception-Reasoning-Action Pipelines," **IEEE ICCA 2025**. [10.1109/ICCA66035.2025.11430865](https://doi.org/10.1109/ICCA66035.2025.11430865)

OPEN-SOURCE RESEARCH SOFTWARE

All repositories include reproducible experimental pipelines and Zenodo-archived datasets.

- **LagrangianCTDE** — Constrained MARL for disaster response (PyTorch, MAPPO, Lagrangian safety constraints). ([Repository](#))
- **Prompt Injection Defense** — LangChain middleware with 3 detection modes and 4 policy strategies. ([Repository](#))
- **AquaAgent** — MAPPO-based leak detection for water networks with EPANET 2.2 digital twin. ([Repository](#))
- Full list of 10+ repositories at github.com/aliakarma, each with Zenodo DOIs for citability.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: Python, Java, SQL; PyTorch, NumPy, scikit-learn, Hugging Face Transformers, PuLP

AI & RL Methods: Multi-agent RL (MAPPO, CTDE), C-Dec-POMDP, Lagrangian constrained optimization, LLM orchestration, adversarial robustness, digital twin simulation

Safety & Governance: Failure-mode analysis, policy-aligned control, blockchain audit trails, prompt-injection defense, SHAP/LIME explainability

Research Tools: LaTeX, Git, Linux, Jupyter, EPANET 2.2, REST APIs, Zenodo, PRISMA systematic reviews

AWARDS & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Merit-Based Fully Funded Scholarship** — Islamic University of Madinah (competitive international selection, 2023)
- **Certificate of Appreciation (Research Excellence)** — ICETAS 2026, for research contribution on agentic AI governance
- **Certificate of Appreciation** — ICBDT 2025, for presented research contributions
- **Mindware: Critical Thinking for the Information Age** — University of Michigan (Coursera), 2024
- **Computational Thinking for Problem Solving** — University of Michigan (Coursera), 2024

LANGUAGES & SERVICE

Languages: Urdu (native), English (professional proficiency), Arabic (professional proficiency)

Service: Volunteer, Masjid Al-Nabawi, Madinah (Ramadan 2024, 2025) — visitor assistance during peak pilgrimage seasons.